

TVs

GET THE BEST TV FOR YOUR NEEDS
THIS DIWALI

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TVs are, more often than not, one of the most common purchases in India during festivals such as Diwali. However, the actual process of buying a TV can be a drawn-out and arduous one, since there is a wide gamut of options available in the market. Since TV purchases are usually long-term ones, chances are that you're out of touch with the latest trends in this space. This is where we come in, to fill you in with what you need to know before buying a TV this year.

LCD, LED, OLED, QLED, micro-LED... there are numerous panel technologies gracing the market in 2019, each with their own advocates. LCD TVs are archaic and are essentially obsolete, so don't bother with these at all. LED or LED-LCD TVs are basically LCD TVs with LED backlighting, instead of the bulky CCFL-backlit LCD TVs. This allows TVs to be slimmer and practically bezel-free. In the television market, you will see that users looking for affordable but efficient solutions often end up choosing LED TVs.

OLED, on the other hand, is touted to be the best widely-accessible panel technology today and are known for having the darkest-blacks and enhanced contrast. If you've set aside a significant budget for a TV this Diwali and utilise TVs a lot in general, go for OLED panels. Note: OLED panels do tend to suffer burn-ins after prolonged usage, but most of the times, they fade in a while.

Screen size is also an extremely important criterion and it is foolish to think "bigger is better" here. Choose a screen size according to the room you will be

placing it in. If it's a relatively small room, you'd be better off choosing 32 or 40-inch screens. An absurdly-large 65-inch TV screen only makes sense when there's a good 8-10 feet distance between your seating area and the TV.

We recommend that you buy TVs with refresh rates of 60Hz or 120Hz. Higher refresh rates like 240 or even 480 Hz are available in the market. Why not buy these, you ask? Well, they're "effective" refresh rates and not the actual refresh rate. The effective refresh rate is generally half of the value displayed, so a 120Hz effective refresh rate is actually only 60Hz and so on.

Resolution is also important and you have a wide variety of options in this category as well. If you're watching a lot of cable or set-top box TV, stick to FHD (Full HD) – 1920x1080 resolution since a majority of TV and satellite content today maxes out at FHD. However, if you stream a lot, go for 4K. Buying 4K TVs is also a good way to future-proof your investment. Absolutely do not go for 8K TVs now



At just 4.9mm thickness, the MI LED TV 4 Pro is a great option for a 4K LED TV under 50k.

as they're exorbitantly-priced since the technology is in its nascent stage. If you want an 8K TV, wait for a few years until the technology becomes more wide-spread.

HDR or high dynamic range delivers more colours, higher contrast levels and increased brightness. However, this feature shouldn't be the main reason you choose a set, if the one that suits you best, depending on all the aforementioned criteria, has HDR, then its a bonus.

Coming to smart TVs now, these sets are infinitely useful for people who watch content on streaming sites such as Netflix. Apart from streaming, you can also run apps, play games, download on-demand movies, and even use social media sites like Facebook. You could post a status from your TV! Some of the best smart TVs in the market



Sony A8F 4K OLED smart TV is a great purchase

right now are the Sony A9F, Samsung Q9F, LG 55SK8500PTA, Panasonic TH-55FX800D and the LG C8.

However, if you only use the television to watch TV channels, you don't need to get a smart TV, since they are considerably more expensive. Additionally, you can even turn a "dumb" TV into a smart one with streaming devices such as the Google Chromecast, Amazon Firestick and more.

So, you've set aside a budget for a TV this Diwali. We're going to suggest something radical if you want to save most of that money. Buy a Raspberry Pi instead (you don't even need the latest Pi 4) and turn the TV you are presently using into a smart TV by installing KODI, an open-source software media centre. With KODI, you can access tons of content online thereby eliminating the need to buy an expensive smart TV altogether. There are plenty of tutorials online that you guide you step-by-step through this process. 